CHILD SAFETY POLICY

ISSUED 23/10/2025

PURPOSE: The Club is committed to ensuring the **safety, wellbeing, and best interests of all children and young people** who participate in our programs and activities. This commitment is guided by the **Children, Youth and Families Act 2005 (Vic)**, the **Child Wellbeing and Safety Act 2005 (Vic)**, the **Victorian Child Safe Standards**, and the **Basketball Victoria Member Protection Policy**.

We acknowledge our legal and moral responsibility to **protect children from abuse, neglect, and harm** and to promote their rights to feel safe, respected, and supported. This policy sets out how the Club creates a **child-safe environment**, prevents and responds to risks of harm, and fosters a culture where children are heard and protected.

It applies to all **volunteers, members, staff, and anyone involved with the Club**, and is designed to support a culture of vigilance, accountability, and continuous improvement in child safety.

REVISION: All Club policies, procedures guides and checklists are reviewed every January following the appointment of the new committee in November of each year. They may also be reviewed before each season or too meet compliance requirements.

CHILD SAFETY OFFICER: The Club appoints a **Child Safety Officer (CSO)** each year to act as the key contact and champion for child safety. The CSO Guide outlines their role, responsibilities, and practical steps to promote a safe culture, respond to concerns, and support children, families, and volunteers.

The CSO is a supportive, informed presence, ensuring the Club meets its obligations under the **Victorian Child Safe Standards** and the **Basketball Victoria Member Protection Policy**.

BENDIGO BASKETBALL ASSOCIATION (BBA) CHILD PROTECTION POLICY: The Club has adopted and is committed to the BBA's policy. You can find the details here.

RAISING CONCERNS: At the Club, the safety and wellbeing of children and young people is everyone's responsibility. All volunteers, members, families and anyone involved with the Club are encouraged to speak up if they observe or suspect any behaviour, situation, or incident that may compromise a child's safety.

How to Raise a Concern

1. **Direct Contact with the Child Safety Officer (CSO)**
    - The CSO is the first point of contact for child safety concerns.
    - Concerns can be raised in person, by phone, or via email.
    - The CSO will listen, provide guidance, and ensure the concern is handled appropriately.
2. **Committee Contact**

PHOENIX UNITED BASKETBALL DEVELOPMENT CLUB INC
HELLO@BENDIGOPHOENIX.ORG.AU WWW.BENDIGOPHOENIX.ORG.AU

- If the CSO is unavailable or the concern involves the CSO, contact the Club President or another committee member.

3. **External Reporting**

   - For serious concerns involving suspected abuse or immediate risk, external authorities must be contacted:

     - **Victoria Police (Emergency)** – 000
     - **Child Protection – Central Intake** – 1800 675 598
     - **Basketball Victoria Integrity Unit** – integrity@basketballvictoria.com.au

What to Include When Reporting a Concern

- Who was involved (child, adult, witness).
- When and where the incident occurred.
- Description of what happened (facts only; avoid assumptions or opinions).
- Any immediate actions taken to protect the child.
- The child's own words, if disclosed.

Confidentiality

- Concerns will be handled confidentially.
- Information will only be shared with those responsible for managing child safety or external authorities as required.

No Repercussions

- Anyone raising a concern in good faith will not face retaliation, discrimination, or disadvantage.

Follow-Up

The CSO or Committee will provide updates to the person raising the concern, where appropriate, on the actions taken and outcomes.

TRAINING AND RESOURCES: The Club encourages all volunteers to read and complete the following free resources:

- **Basketball Victoria Child Safe Standards - information and resources including polices and recommended training for dealing with child safety and misconduct.**

- **Child Safe Sport Victoria - information and resources for the Child Safety Officer and committee members including webinars and tools tailored to community sport in Victoria.**

- **Department of Education - comprehensive background on the standards, tools and training links for organisations working with children.**

RELATED POLICIES:

- All Code of Conduct policies
- Volunteer Policy
- Privacy Policy
- Complaints and Grievance Policy
- Child Supervision Policy